

28/09/2025

Callous, Shun, Nab, Sniff, Stiff

1. Callous (निर्मम / कठोर) (Adjective) (' kæləs) (Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** Showing insensitive and cruel disregard for others.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** दूसरों के प्रति संवेदनहीन और निर्दयी।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *callosus* → **English callous**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Heartless, Insensitive
 - **Antonym:** Compassionate, Sensitive
- **Connotation:** Strongly negative
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A manager ignores the struggles of employees during layoffs.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Callous behavior is often observed in organizational or social contexts where empathy is low. Leaders or individuals acting callously may make decisions prioritizing efficiency or self-interest over human impact. This approach can lead to dissatisfaction, distrust, or conflict. Psychological studies link callousness to lack of emotional engagement and low

moral concern. Understanding and identifying callous behavior helps in building resilient teams and establishing ethical practices. Training in emotional intelligence encourages individuals to replace callous tendencies with empathy, improving relationships, communication, and organizational culture.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- **Correct:** His callous remarks hurt her deeply. (उसकी निर्दयी टिप्पणियों ने उसे गहराई से चोट पहुँचाई।)
- **Incorrect:** He was callous with a feather. (वह पंख के साथ कठोर था। (*misuse: inappropriate context*))

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Spot callousness in yourself by observing reactions to others' discomfort. Pause before responding; if indifferent, consciously engage empathy. Replace cold detachment with thoughtful consideration. Small acts of compassion gradually soften callous tendencies.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- The callous landlord ignored the tenant's plea for repairs. (निर्दयी मकान मालिक ने मरम्मत के लिए किरायेदार की याचना को अनसुना किया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The callous landlord
 - V (Verb – Transitive): ignored
 - O (Object): the tenant's plea for repairs

- **Common Collocations:**

- callous attitude, callous remark, callous behavior

- **My Statement:**

- The callous attitude of the manager creates a negative atmosphere in the workplace.
- Due to her callous behavior, she was ousted from her position at the company.
- Even a single callous remark can ruin someone's mental state.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

2. Shun (अलग रहना / परहेज़ करना) (Verb) (ʃʌn) (Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** To deliberately avoid someone or something.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जानबूझकर किसी से या किसी चीज़ से परहेज़ करना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *scunian* → **English shun**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Avoid, Eschew
 - **Antonym:** Embrace, Welcome
- **Connotation:** Negative (implies exclusion)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Villagers shunning a person accused of wrongdoing.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Shunning is a social behavior used to signal disapproval or maintain moral boundaries. Religious communities may shun members who violate codes of conduct. In workplaces, individuals may shun colleagues exhibiting toxic behavior. Shunning has psychological implications, leading to isolation, stress, and behavioral adjustment. It serves as both a social control mechanism and a coping strategy. Understanding when and why people are shunned can inform conflict resolution and social integration strategies, highlighting

the importance of empathy, accountability, and structured communication to avoid unnecessary social alienation.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- **Correct:** The villagers shunned him after the scandal. (कांड के बाद गाँववालों ने उसे परहेज़ किया।)
- **Incorrect:** She shunned the table. (उसने मेज से परहेज़ किया।) (*misuse: inanimate object not contextually relevant*)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Identify what or whom to shun wisely. Avoid distractions, toxic people, or bad habits. Mental and physical boundaries strengthen personal growth. Thoughtful avoidance protects energy; impulsive shunning harms relationships. Use selective shunning as a strategic tool, not reactive behavior.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- She shunned social gatherings after the argument. (बहस के बाद उसने सामाजिक समारोहों से परहेज़ किया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Transitive): shunned
 - O (Object): social gatherings
 - (Adverbial/Additional Info): after the argument

- **Common Collocations:**

- shun someone, shun attention, shun responsibility

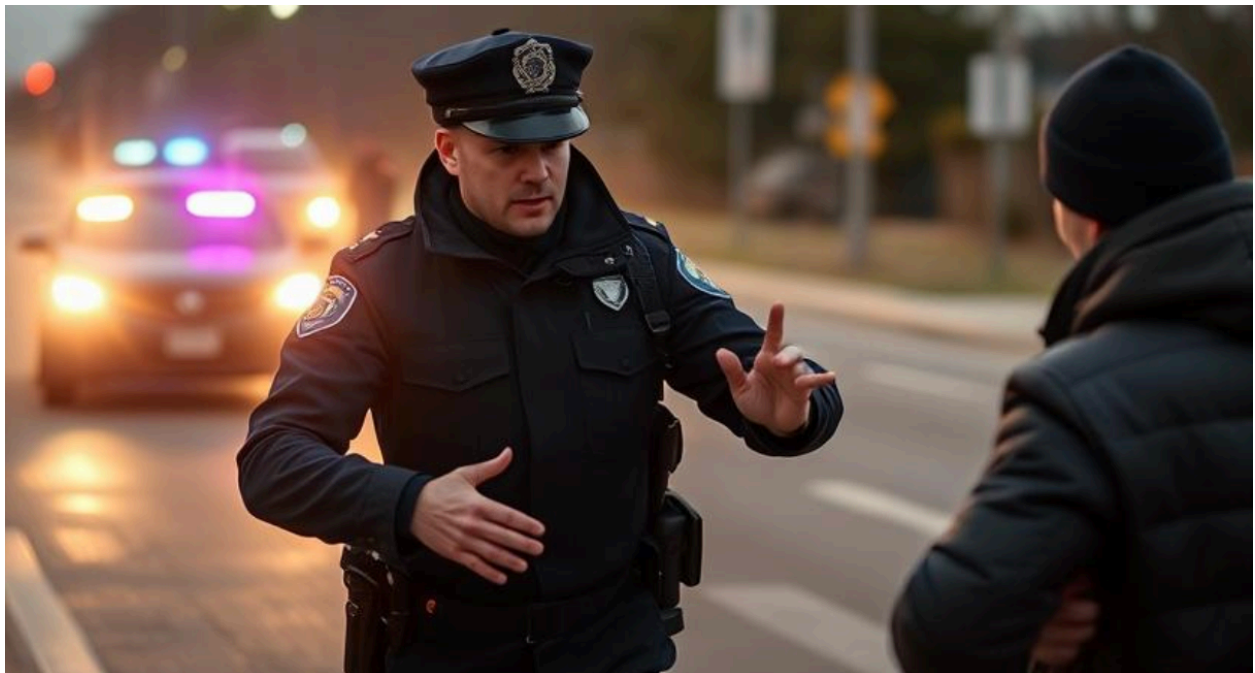
- **My Statement:**

- He often shuns responsibilities at the last moment when they are most needed.
- The new actor shuns attention from the media and focuses on his role.
- You can shun the habit of drinking too much by meditating daily.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

3. Nab (पकड़ना / गिरफ्तार करना) (Verb) (næb) (Neutral/Informal)

- **Meaning (English):** To catch, seize, or arrest someone or something quickly.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जल्दी पकड़ना या गिरफ्तार करना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Middle English *nabben* → **English nab**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Capture, Seize
 - **Antonym:** Release, Free
- **Connotation:** Neutral to informal; sometimes playful
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A police officer nabbing a thief in a chase.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Law enforcement frequently nabs criminals during sting operations. In sports or games, players nab opportunities for quick gains. Nab implies rapid action with skill or alertness. Journalists may nab scoops before competitors, while students may nab the last seat in a classroom. The term often carries a sense of immediacy and effectiveness. Recognizing moments to nab opportunities can enhance professional and personal success. The psychological aspect of readiness, anticipation, and decisiveness is key in

effectively nabbing targets, whether tangible, like objects, or abstract, like chances or information.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- **Correct:** The police nabbed the thief before he escaped. (पुलिस ने चोर को भागने से पहले पकड़ लिया।)
- **Incorrect:** She nabbed a chair and held it forever. (सने एक कुर्सी पकड़ ली और हमेशा पकड़े रखा।) (*misuse: exaggerates continuous action*)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Stay alert to nab fleeting opportunities. Quick recognition plus decisive action increases success. Think of life as a series of small, snatched wins; nabbing them builds momentum. Timing and readiness make all the difference between success and regret.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- He nabbed the last train just in time. (उसने आखिरी ट्रेन को समय पर पकड़ लिया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): He
 - V (Verb – Transitive): nabbed
 - O (Object): the last train
 - (Adverbial/Additional Info): just in time

- **Common Collocations:**

- nab a thief, nab a seat, nab an opportunity

- **My Statement:**

- He nabbed the offer immediately.
- The police officer nabbed the robbers before they could escape.
- He quickly nabbed an outfit in the store before anyone else bought it.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

4. Sniff (सूंघना / गंध लेना) (Verb) (snif) (Neutral)

- **Meaning (English):** To draw in air through the nose, often to detect a smell.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** नाक के माध्यम से हवा लेना, अक्सर गंध पहचानने के लिए।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Middle English *snifen* → **English sniff**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Smell, Inhale
 - **Antonym:** Exhale, Ignore
- **Connotation:** Neutral; can be literal or figurative
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A dog sniffing the ground for clues.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Sniffing is critical in biological research, law enforcement, and animal behavior studies. Dogs sniff to detect drugs, explosives, or diseases. Humans sniff food or perfume to evaluate freshness or aroma. Figuratively, people sniff out opportunities or deceit, implying investigative curiosity. Recognizing subtle signals through sniffing, literally or metaphorically, helps in decision-making and early problem detection. Teaching children and professionals to pay attention to small details—“sniffing” them out—enhances

observation skills and situational awareness, which are crucial for both personal and professional growth.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- **Correct:** The dog sniffed the package carefully. (कुत्ते ने पैकेज को ध्यान से सूंघा।)
- **Incorrect:** He sniffed the computer. (उसने कंप्यूटर को सूंघा।) (*misuse: inappropriate object*)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Sniff out important cues before acting. Observe details carefully, literally or figuratively. Small clues often indicate bigger trends or problems. Cultivate the habit of sniffing subtle signals to make smarter, informed decisions rather than reacting blindly.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- She sniffed the aroma of fresh coffee. (उसने ताजे कॉफी की खुशबू सूंघी।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Transitive): sniffed
 - O (Object): the aroma of fresh coffee

- **Common Collocations:**

- sniff out, sniff the air, sniff around

- **My Statement:**

- The dog sniffed the person to detect narcotics.
- People often sniff the food and make assumptions about its taste.
- As she sniffed the new fragrance, she ended up buying some.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

5. Stiff (कठोर / अकड़ापन) (Adjective) (stif) (Neutral/Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** Rigid, not easily bent or moved; can describe physical or figurative rigidity.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** कठोर, अकड़ा हुआ
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *stif* → **English *stiff***
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Rigid, Firm
 - **Antonym:** Flexible, Soft
- **Connotation:** Neutral to negative, depending on context
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A stiff board or a person with stiff posture.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Stiffness can refer to physical, emotional, or social rigidity. In ergonomics, stiff furniture causes discomfort; in social behavior, stiff formalities hinder communication. Physical training often targets stiff muscles to improve flexibility. Workplace training may address stiff hierarchical structures limiting collaboration. Figuratively, a stiff response can indicate lack of empathy. Recognizing stiffness allows interventions—whether stretching

muscles, loosening protocols, or softening communication styles—to enhance productivity, comfort, and relationships.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- **Correct:** The fabric was stiff after washing. (धोने के बाद कपड़ा कठोर हो गया।)
- **Incorrect:** He was stiff with joy. (वह खुशी के साथ अकड़ा हुआ था।) (*misuse: wrong figurative application*)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Reduce stiffness in work, posture, and mindset. Small adjustments daily prevent long-term rigidity. Flexibility improves comfort, creativity, and efficiency. Identify stiff areas and apply targeted changes gradually. Rigidity may feel safe, but adaptability sustains growth.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- His muscles were stiff after the workout. (व्यायाम के बाद उसकी मांसपेशियाँ अकड़ी हुई थीं।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): His muscles
 - V (Verb – Linking): were
 - O (Object/Complement): stiff
 - **(Adverbial/Additional Info): after the workout**
 - ↳ S: — (None; linking verb with complement)
 - ↳ V: — (Linking verb “were” connects subject to complement)

- **Common Collocations:**

- stiff muscles, stiff competition, stiff upper lip, stiff fabric

- **My Statement:**

- The stiff muscles made it harder to perform flexible movements.
- When I put these clothes out to dry under the sun, they became really stiff.
- You were worried about the stiff competition, but did you realize how it was helping you?

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]